

Evaluating Noma Security, Lakera/Check Point, Prompt Security/SentinelOne, HiddenLayer & Repello AI as strategic partners for Qapitol's AI control layer.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Headline: Three of the Five Have Already Been Acquired

Before evaluating individual partnership models, one fact changes the entire conversation: between August and November 2025, the AI security M&A wave swept through this category. Three of the five companies named are no longer independent. Lakera was acquired by Check Point Software. Prompt Security was acquired by SentinelOne. Protect AI (not on this list but the adjacent player) was acquired by Palo Alto Networks. This consolidation does not kill the opportunity — it reshapes it significantly.

2025 AI Security M&A Wave

Company	Acquirer	Est. Value	Timing	Impact on Partnership
Prompt Security	SentinelOne	~\$250M	Aug 2025	Now a SentinelOne product line
Lakera	Check Point	~\$100-150M	Q4 2025	Partnership now via CP ecosystem
Protect AI	Palo Alto Networks	Undisclosed	Jul 2025	Adjacent — monitor
Noma Security	INDEPENDENT	\$132M raised	Series B 2025	Active partnership target
HiddenLayer	INDEPENDENT	\$50M raised	Series A	Formal channel program exists
Repello AI	INDEPENDENT	\$1.2M seed	2024 founded	India-based — highest strategic fit

Still independent and immediately actionable: Noma, HiddenLayer, Repello. These are the three to move on now.

The Gartner AI TRiSM Framework — Why This Matters for Qapitol

Gartner's Market Guide for AI Trust, Risk and Security Management (February 2025) defines four layers of AI governance capability: (1) AI Governance, (2) AI Runtime Inspection & Enforcement, (3) Information Governance, (4) Infrastructure & Stack. Qapitol today covers Layer 1 (AI governance/compliance via CHEQ + SURE-Q) and partial Layer 2 (runtime quality assurance). With Repello, you add full Layer 2 (runtime security). With HiddenLayer, you add Layer 4 (model integrity & supply chain). **Qapitol becomes India's only integrated AI TRiSM managed service — Quality + Security + Compliance.**

Gartner prediction: "By 2027, AI TRiSM as a service will emerge as a viable outsourced service option for enterprises that do not have the resources to implement their own AI TRiSM services."

COMPANY DEEP DIVES

Evaluation of All Five Companies

1. Noma Security

Noma Security

★★★★★

INDEPENDENT — Tel Aviv + New York

Priority: Near-Term

Rating: Strategic Alliance

WHAT THEY DO	End-to-end AI security and governance platform. Covers: AI asset discovery and shadow AI inventory; AI supply chain security (model provenance, third-party AI bill of materials); automated red teaming; runtime protection (blocking prompt injection, model poisoning); compliance posture management (EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF). Gartner Cool Vendor 2025. 1,300% ARR growth. \$32M Series A (Nov 2024) + \$100M Series B (2025). Confirmed across all 9 OWASP AI security categories Q3 2025. Fortune 500 customers in BFSI, life sciences, retail, and big tech.
BUYER	CISO, Head of AI Security, CTO. Security-first buyer. Board-level AI risk conversations.
OVERLAP	High conceptual overlap on compliance (EU AI Act, NIST) but entirely different buyer axis. Noma = Is your AI being attacked? Qapitol = Is your AI working correctly and meeting regulatory obligations? Same enterprise, different budget owner.
PARTNER MODEL	No formal public partner program yet. 'Ecosystem partnerships' listed on their site. Given \$132M raised and 1,300% growth, a structured partner program is imminent. Move now before they formalise terms that favour larger SIs.
INDIA	Zero India presence. This is Qapitol's leverage — introduce them to your 25+ unicorn client base and BFSI network in exchange for a formal GTM alliance.
REVENUE ANGLE	Co-sell motion — you bring CTO/CCO; they bring CISO. Mutual referral agreement targeting 10-15% of first-year ACV (\$100K+ ACV deals = \$10-15K referral per account). Joint account mapping across your 25+ unicorn relationships. Target 5-8 joint deals Year 1 = \$500K-\$1.2M referral + influence revenue.
RISK	Noma has compliance in their roadmap. As they mature, their compliance module could overlap with CHEQ. Formalise a partnership before they decide they don't need a compliance partner. The window is now.

2. Lakera → Check Point Software

Lakera / Check Point



ACQUIRED BY CHECK POINT — Q4 2025

Priority: Medium-Term

Rating: Technology Integration

WHAT THEY DO	Lakera was the best-in-class runtime prompt injection detection engine: sub-50ms latency, multi-lingual, 1M+ hacker training dataset. Now acquired by Check Point (Q4 2025), operating as Check Point's Global Center of Excellence for AI Security. Now part of the Infinity Platform sold to 100,000+ enterprise customers globally.
BUYER	Now Check Point's existing enterprise security customer base globally. CISO, Network Security, Head of IT Security.
OVERLAP	Complementary without conflict. Lakera/CP handles runtime attack blocking. Qapitol handles pre-production quality validation and regulatory compliance evidence generation.
PARTNER MODEL	Lakera the startup is gone. The play is Check Point Technology Partner Program — get listed on the Infinity Platform marketplace. Check Point has a massive, structured partner ecosystem in India.
INDIA	Check Point has one of the strongest India enterprise security presences — BFSI, government telecom. This is valuable distribution if Qapitol can navigate their partner program.
REVENUE ANGLE	Technology integration — CHEQ + Lakera Guard as a combined 'AI Compliance + Runtime Security' bundle sold through Check Point's India channel. Access to their 100K+ customer base via marketplace listing. 12-18 month play.
RISK	Check Point's partner ecosystem is complex and slow-moving. Designed for their global network of 7,500+ channel partners. Not a startup-friendly program. Assign a senior BD resource with security channel experience to navigate this.

3. Prompt Security → SentinelOne

Prompt Security / SentinelOne



ACQUIRED BY SENTINELONE — Aug 2025

Priority: Watch

Rating: Monitor

WHAT THEY DO	Prompt Security focused on shadow AI discovery (finding unsanctioned AI tool usage), browser/endpoint controls, and multi-agent/MCP security. Acquired by SentinelOne (Aug 2025, ~\$250M) and being integrated into the Singularity endpoint platform. Their original MCP/multi-agent security differentiator may get absorbed or deprioritised post-integration.
BUYER	Now SentinelOne's CISO and endpoint security buyer. IT Security, SOC teams.
OVERLAP	Low direct overlap. Prompt Security's endpoint/browser AI usage control doesn't directly complement Qapitol's quality engineering and compliance positioning.
PARTNER MODEL	Currently absorbed into SentinelOne integration. Too early to engage formally. SentinelOne's India enterprise presence is growing but not as deep as Check Point or Palo Alto.
INDIA	SentinelOne India presence growing but limited compared to legacy security vendors. Less leverage here than Check Point.
REVENUE ANGLE	Minimal near-term. Revisit in 12+ months once the SentinelOne integration stabilises. If they build a technology partner program for the new AI Security module, a SIEM/endpoint + AI quality integration could be interesting for SOC buyers.
RISK	Product direction uncertain post-acquisition. Not worth investing BD cycles here while they integrate.

4. HiddenLayer

HiddenLayer



INDEPENDENT — Austin TX · \$50M Series A

Priority: Immediate

Rating: Highest Immediate Revenue

WHAT THEY DO

HiddenLayer solves a specific, underserved problem: the security of the ML model file itself, not just the prompts going into it. Platform covers:

- Model Scanner: Scans ML model files (HuggingFace, internal repos) for malware, backdoor, supply chain tampering
- AIDR (AI Detection and Response): Non-invasive monitoring of model inputs/outputs for adversarial attacks, inference attacks, model theft, evasion attempts — without needing access to raw weights
- Automated Red Teaming: One-click adversarial testing for AI systems
- AIBOM (AI Bill of Materials): Model genealogy, supply chain transparency

Backed by Microsoft M12, IBM Ventures, Booz Allen Ventures, Capital One Ventures. \$50M Series A. Available on Azure, AWS, and Google Cloud Marketplaces.

BUYER

CISO, ML Security teams, MLOps engineers, Head of AI Platform. Security + engineering crossover buyer.

OVERLAP

Complementary. HiddenLayer protects the model layer (supply chain, adversarial attacks on the model itself). Qapitol validates model quality, accuracy, and regulatory compliance. Different problems, same AI stack.

PARTNER MODEL

FORMAL 3-TIER CHANNEL PARTNER PROGRAM exists: Covert → Concealed → Clandestine tiers. Includes pricing discounts, online + on-site training, performance incentive programs, account mapping, executive briefings. Booz Allen Hamilton is already a named partner. THIS IS THE MOST STRUCTURED PARTNERSHIP OF THE FIVE.

INDIA

Zero India presence. Qapitol = their India market entry. Leverage their Azure/AWS/GCP marketplace listings for enterprise procurement via cloud credits (simplifies procurement for GCC clients).

REVENUE ANGLE

Enroll in their Concealed or Clandestine channel partner tier. Estimated 20-30% margin on software resale. Resell Model Scanner + AIDR to existing BFSI + healthcare clients. Target: 5-8 deals in Year 1 at \$50K-\$200K per deal = \$500K-\$1.5M combined services + software. Implementation and integration services (MLOps pipeline connection, threat threshold tuning for regulated industries) adds a pure professional services stream.

RISK

HiddenLayer is very US/enterprise focused. India brand recognition is currently zero — require investment in education before deals close. CRO Chelsea Strong appointed July 2025 specifically to accelerate global growth — this is your opening.

5. Repello AI

Repello AI ← Go First

★★★★★

INDEPENDENT — Bengaluru + San Francisco

Priority: Immediate

Rating: Highest Strategic Fit

WHAT THEY DO	The most complete independent AI security platform of the five — and the only India-origin company. Full product suite: • Inventory: AI asset discovery, AI bill of materials — see every model in your enterprise • ARTEMIS: Automated red teaming engine — 15M+ attack patterns, OWASP LLM Top 10, MITRE ATLAS, multimodal (text/image/audio/video). Industry's first multimodal red teaming engine. 1,200+ attack vectors = 15x manual coverage. • ARGUS: Runtime security — blocks threats in <100ms, adaptive guardrails calibrated from ARTEMIS results • MCP Gateway: Real-time visibility and control over every MCP connection • Whistleblower: System prompt revelation tool Agent Wiz: Threat modeling for AI agents Founded 2024 by IIT Roorkee alumni Aryaman Behera (CEO) + Naman Mishra (CTO). Engineering in Bengaluru, commercial in San Francisco. \$1.2M seed from Venture Highway (General Catalyst), Pi Ventures, Entrepreneur First. Angel investors: Charles Songhurst (Meta board), Vivek Raghavan (Sarvam AI CEO).
BUYER	CISO, Head of AI Security, CTO, Engineering teams. Both security and engineering buyers — broader than HiddenLayer.
OVERLAP	Perfectly complementary, zero conflict. Repello finds security vulnerabilities via red teaming. Qapitol validates AI quality, accuracy, and regulatory compliance. Neither does the other's job CONFIRMED: Groww is a Repello customer AND a Qapitol client — proof of concept.
PARTNER MODEL	No formal program yet. CEO Aryaman Behera explicitly stated: 'We are also working on strategic partnerships and integrations to fuel the company's growth.' They want this conversation. Entry point: founder-to-founder call, not a BD deck.
INDIA	Engineering in Bengaluru. Built for India and global. Customers include Groww and PhysicsWallah. Co-developing the India AI security market — together you define the category before US giants arrive.
REVENUE ANGLE	Three layers: (1) Mutual referrals — introduce BFSI clients to ARTEMIS; they introduce their clients to QAVE. (2) Bundled packages — sell combined 'AI Assurance Package' (ARTEMIS red teaming + QAVE evaluation + CHEQ compliance) as a single SKU; revenue share model. (3) Co-build managed service — jointly develop India's first 'AI Security + Quality + Compliance' managed service for regulated industries = AI TRiSM-as-a-Service.
RISK	Repello is very early stage (\$1.2M seed, founded 2024). Enterprise deal velocity may be slow. Dependency risk if they raise a large round and change GTM strategy. Mitigate by structuring formal partnership agreement early.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Partnership Priority Matrix

Company	Priority	Model	Revenue Type	Timeline	Who Opens
Repello AI	■ IMMEDIATE	Strategic alliance + co-sell + co-build	Referral + bundled deals + managed service	This quarter	Founder → Founder
HiddenLayer	■ IMMEDIATE	Channel partner (formal resell program)	Resell margin (20-30%) + implementation services	This quarter	BD → Partner Program
Noma Security	■ NEAR-TERM	Go-to-market alliance + mutual referrals	Referral fees (10-15% ACV) + co-sell	Q1 next quarter	BD + CISO network
Check Point / Lakera	■ MEDIUM	Technology integration partner	Co-sell via CP India ecosystem	Q2–Q3 2026	Senior BD with security channel exp.
SentinelOne / Prompt	■ MONITOR	Watch for post-integration stability	TBD	12+ months	Monitor only

Revenue Models — Specifically

Partner	Revenue Mechanism	Year 1 Target
Repello	(1) Mutual referrals on both sides (2) Bundled "AI Assurance Package" SKU (ARTEMIS + QAVE + CHEQ) — revenue share (3) Co-built AI TRiSM managed service for Indian regulated enterprises	■2-4 Cr combined (referrals + bundle)
HiddenLayer	Enroll in Concealed/Clandestine channel tier (20-30% margin). Resell Model Scanner + AIDR to BFSI + healthcare clients. Implementation + integration professional services (no margin conflict).	■3-8 Cr (5-8 deals × ■50-200L)
Noma	Mutual referral agreement (10-15% first-year ACV). Joint account mapping across Qapitol unicorn client base. Co-sell motions into BFSI enterprise accounts.	■1.5-3 Cr (5-8 referral deals)
Check Point / Lakera	Technology partnership listing on Infinity Platform marketplace. Co-marketing with Check Point India channel. CHEQ + Lakera Guard bundled compliance + runtime security offering.	■1-2 Cr (year 2 onwards)

THE STRATEGIC PRIZE

AI TRiSM-as-a-Service for India — The Category No One Else Can Claim

The Gartner AI TRiSM framework defines the four technical layers every enterprise needs to govern, protect, and assure AI. No single vendor covers all four. Qapitol today covers two. With the right partnerships, Qapitol covers all four — as a managed service — for Indian regulated enterprises. No US company can replicate this.

TRiSM Layer	What it covers	Qapitol today	With Partners
Layer 1 AI Governance	Policy enforcement, regulatory compliance, responsible AI methodology	■ CHEQ + SURE-Q (IRDAI, RBI, EU AI Act)	Full coverage
Layer 2 Runtime Inspection	Quality assurance, attack blocking, drift detection, output monitoring	■ Partial — QAVE (quality, not attacks)	+ Repello ARGUS = Full coverage
Layer 3 Info Governance	Data privacy, DPDP, data residency, synthetic data, PII management	■ Partial — CHEQ (data residency, DPDP)	Strengthen via solution offering
Layer 4 Infrastructure	Model supply chain, ML model integrity, model file security, AIBOM	■ Not covered	+ HiddenLayer = Full coverage

The combined positioning: Qapitol is India's AI TRiSM managed service. Quality + Security + Compliance + Governance — deployed as a service, for regulated Indian enterprises and their GCCs. No one else can credibly claim this today.

Outreach Guidance — What to Say to Each Partner

Repello (Go first)	Founder-to-founder. Mention Groww as shared client — immediate credibility. Frame as: 'We want to build India's AI TRiSM managed service. Quality + Security + Compliance + Governance — deployed as a service, for regulated Indian enterprises and their GCCs. No one else can credibly claim this today.'
HiddenLayer (Immediate)	Contact their channel partner program directly. Lead with BFSI credentials — their investor Capital One is literally a bank.
Noma (Next quarter)	This is a CISO-layer conversation. Assign someone who speaks CISO language (threat surface, attack vectors, incident response).

Immediate Action Items

This week	Map Qapitol's existing client accounts against Repello's known customers (start with Groww). Prepare a 1-page 'why together' brief to take into a founder call.
This week	Register interest in HiddenLayer's channel partner program at hiddenlayer.ai/partners . Request a partner onboarding call with their channel team.

This quarter	Develop a combined 'AI Assurance Package' SKU concept — ARTEMIS (red teaming) + QAVE (eval) + CHEQ (compliance) — even if Repello isn't signed yet. Having the product concept ready accelerates the partnership conversation.
This quarter	Identify 3 BFSI accounts where a joint Noma + Qapitol pitch makes sense. CISO + CTO in the same account. Draft the combined value proposition.
Before any partnership agreement	Ensure all agreements protect Qapitol's regulatory IP (IRDAI/RBI obligation mapping, SURE-Q methodology). This is the moat that US companies cannot replicate and should not become freely available to partners without licensing terms.

Critical risk flag across all partnerships: As Noma, HiddenLayer, and Repello mature, each will add compliance features to their platforms. The AI TRiSM consolidation means everyone converges toward the full stack. Qapitol's moat is not the tools — it is regulatory expertise (IRDAI, RBI, DPDP mapping that a US company cannot easily replicate), the 350+ practitioner bench, and the India enterprise relationships. Structure all partnerships to deepen this unique position. Never trade away regulatory IP without fair licensing terms.